

**United States History and Government
Content-Specific Rubric (Questions 31-36)
Civic Literacy Essay Question (Question 37)
January 2026**

Document 1

. . . The prohibition movement was an outgrowth of the temperance crusades of the first half of the nineteenth century. Hard drinking was almost the rule among the Fathers of the Republic. The per capita consumption of spirits in the early days was many times what it is now, and beer drinking was almost unknown. After the War of 1812, there grew up in the New England States a large commerce in West Indian rum, which was consumed extensively, especially in Maine, supplementing the consumption of heavy liquors which were manufactured in those States. Maine alone, in 1827, when her population was 360,000, manufactured 1,333,160 gallons of liquor, and it was sold at retail in nearly every store and tavern. Drunkenness in its worst form, involving disastrous social consequences, was widespread. Sufficient evidence of it was to be found in the number of persons in the jails and poorhouses. . . .

Source: L. Ames Brown, "Prohibition," *The North American Review*, November 1915

31 According to L. Ames Brown, what is *one* historical circumstance surrounding the issue of Prohibition?

Score of 1:

- States a historical circumstance surrounding the issue of Prohibition according to L. Ames Brown
Examples: Prohibition movement outgrowth of temperance crusades of first half of 19th century; hard drinking almost rule among Fathers of Republic; per capita consumption of spirits in early days many times what it was in 1915; growth of large commerce in West Indian rum in New England states after War of 1812; West Indian rum consumed extensively, especially in Maine; heavy liquors manufactured in New England states supplemented with West Indian rum; 1,333,160 gallons of liquor manufactured in Maine in 1827 and sold at retail in nearly every store and tavern; drunkenness involving disastrous social consequences widespread; jails and poorhouses evidence of social consequences of drunkenness

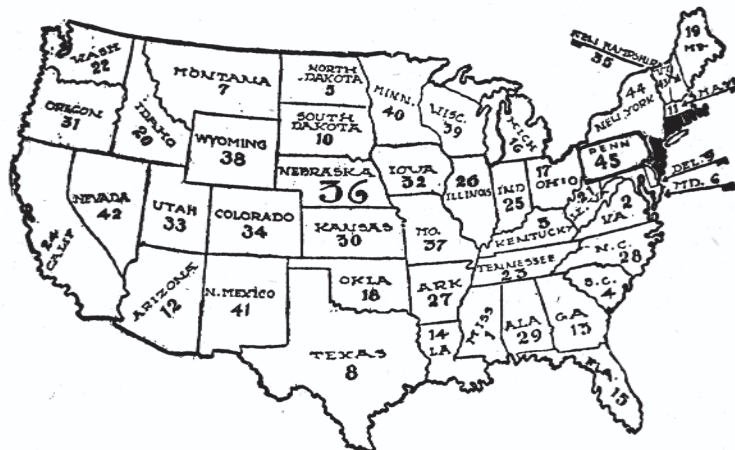
Score of 0:

- Incorrect response
Examples: temperance crusade outgrowth of Prohibition movement; increase in consumption of spirits as compared to early days; beer consumed extensively in early days; heavy liquors not manufactured in the United States; rum manufactured in New England
- Vague response
Examples: Prohibition movement outgrowth; Fathers of the Republic; per capital consumption; New England states after War of 1812; consumption supplemented; Maine's population 360,000 in 1827; it changed things
- No response

National Prohibition

RATIFICATION MAP

Numbers Indicate Order in which States have Ratified the National Prohibition Amendment



This map shows on this date, January 31, 1919, that there are yet only four states which have not ratified. Three of these, Pennsylvania, Connecticut and Rhode Island, are expected to ratify at an early date. Even New Jersey may ratify and make the result unanimous.

STATEMENT OF THE NATIONAL LEGISLATIVE COMMITTEE OF THE ANTI-SALOON LEAGUE OF AMERICA

The ratification of the Prohibition amendment to the constitution is the consummation of more than twenty-five years of effort on the part of the Anti-Saloon League, representing as it has the moral and religious forces of the nation. It is the greatest victory for moral reform in America since the Declaration of Independence.

Not less in importance to that which has already been accomplished is the vitally essential task now before the Prohibition forces of securing from Congress and the states proper enforcement legislation and the crystallizing of public sentiment in the large cities and wet districts for complete enforcement of the law.

With Prohibition assured for this nation, the American anti-liquor forces need to redouble their efforts for the larger task of world Prohibition of the manufacture and sale of all intoxicating beverages.

James Cannon, Jr.,
Wayne B. Wheeler,
Arthur J. Barton,
Ernest H. Clerrington,
Legislative Committee.

P. A. Baker, General Superintendent.
E. C. Dinwiddie, Legislative Superintendent.

Source: Anti-Saloon League of America, 1919

32 According to this poster, what is *one* historical circumstance surrounding the issue of Prohibition?

Score of 1:

- States a historical circumstance surrounding the issue of Prohibition according to this poster
Examples: as of January 31, 1919, only four states had not ratified Prohibition amendment; result for ratification of Prohibition amendment expected to be unanimous; more than twenty-five years of effort by Anti-Saloon League to ratify Prohibition; representation by Anti-Saloon League of moral and religious forces of nation; work of Prohibition forces to secure proper enforcement legislation from Congress and the states; crystallization of public sentiment in large cities/wet districts for complete enforcement of law needed; efforts of anti-liquor forces need to be redoubled for larger task of world Prohibition

Score of 0:

- Incorrect response
Examples: New Jersey only state not to ratify Prohibition; National Legislative Committee of Anti-Saloon League of America repealed Prohibition; National Prohibition amendment not ratified by western states
- Vague response
Examples: moral reform since Declaration of Independence; greatest victory for reform; vitally essential task; larger task of the world; the states ratified this amendment in order from 1 – 44
- No response

Document 3

. . . Over his first three years in the White House Hoover never wavered in his support for Prohibition. In 1929 he signed the “Five and Ten Law” making every liquor violation a felony, and his Justice Department ramped up federal enforcement. “We enormously increased the jail population,” by jailing Prohibition violators Hoover recalled in his memoirs. “We multiplied the fines, padlocking, and confiscations.” Yet all this aggressive action he ascribed [attributed] to his duty as a constitutional officer, not to his actual endorsement. On this basic political question, Hoover declined to share his feelings and refused to act on them. . . .

During the 1928 campaign Hoover famously saluted Prohibition as “a great social and economic experiment, noble in motive and far-reaching in purpose.” But three years later, surely the test had been run. . . .

By early 1932 little doubt remained as to the mood of the electorate. Respondents to a national mail-in survey conducted by *The Literary Digest* in February and March endorsed repeal of the Eighteenth Amendment by a four-to-one margin. Residents of Ohio, the birthplace of Prohibition, sent in 112,026 ballots for repeal and just 43,284 for keeping the ban on booze. Kansas was the only state to poll in favor of Prohibition. . . .

Source: Charles Rappleye, *Herbert Hoover in the White House*, Simon & Schuster, 2016 (adapted)

33 Based on this document, what was *one* effort to address the issue of Prohibition?

Score of 1:

- States an effort to address the issue of Prohibition based on this document

Examples: Hoover supported Prohibition in his first three years in the White House; Hoover signed “Five and Ten Law” making every liquor violation a felony; Hoover’s Justice Department ramped up federal enforcement of Prohibition; Prohibition violators jailed; Hoover used his duty as a constitutional officer to multiply fines/padlock/confiscation; in his 1928 campaign Hoover saluted Prohibition as a great social and economic experiment/noble in motive/far-reaching in purpose; by early 1932 respondents to a national mail-in survey endorsed repeal of 18th amendment by a four-to-one margin; residents of Ohio sent in 112,026 ballots to the *Literary Digest* to repeal Prohibition and 43,284 for keeping it; Kansas only state to poll in favor of Prohibition

Score of 0:

- Incorrect response

Examples: federal enforcement of Prohibition ended; by early 1932 everyone supported Prohibition; Kansas supported repeal of Prohibition; Hoover signed laws supporting repeal of Prohibition

- Vague response

Examples: Hoover wavered; actual endorsement; basic political question; Hoover declined to share his feelings; the test had been run; they tried to stop it

- No response

Document 4

... The Women's Organization for National Prohibition Reform (WONPR) was founded in 1929 to show that not all women supported temperance. New York socialite Pauline Sabin led the charge after hearing Ella Boole, the Brooklyn-based leader of the Women's Christian Temperance Union, declare that her support for Prohibition represented "the women of America." On the heels of the successful suffrage campaign that won women the right to vote in 1920, the WONPR, and Sabin in particular, reflected the modern "new woman" of the 1920s. Many members of the WONPR had in fact initially supported the 18th amendment. But they had come to believe that Prohibition had led to a surge in unregulated and particularly underage drinking, as well as a growing sense of distrust for the rule of law. The WONPR's opposition to Prohibition, just like the 18th amendment itself, was not only about drinking, but about the government's role in regulating behavior.

The WONPR did a lot of what we think of now as typical political campaign activities: members attended meetings and gave speeches at rallies, went door-to-door to recruit new supporters, used new technology to spread their message—at the time radio, and lobbied politicians. Wealthy women had founded the organization, and proved able to raise funds even after the Stock Market Crash of 1929 ushered in the Great Depression. From its headquarters in New York City, the organization also gained publicity by organizing events such as a motorcade through New York State. . . .

Source: Sarah Seidman, "The New York Women Who Dismantled Prohibition," Museum of the City of New York, December 15, 2015

34 According to Sarah Seidman, what was *one* effort to address Prohibition?

Score of 1:

- States an effort to address Prohibition according to Sarah Seidman
Examples: Women's Organization for National Prohibition Reform (WONPR) founded in 1929 to show not all women supported temperance; Ella Boole/leader of Women's Christian Temperance Union (WCTU) declared her support for Prohibition represented "the women of America"; many members of WONPR initially supported 18th amendment; many members of WONPR came to oppose Prohibition believing it had led to surge in unregulated/underage drinking/growing sense of distrust for rule of law; WONPR opposed Prohibition on grounds of government's role in regulating behavior; WONPR attended meetings and gave speeches at rallies/went door-to-door to recruit new supporters/used new technology/radio to spread message/lobbied politicians/wealthy women raised funds/gained publicity by organizing events such as a motorcade through New York State

Score of 0:

- Incorrect response
Examples: suffrage campaign lost right to vote in 1920; many members of WONPR continued to support 18th amendment; WONPR supported Prohibition and government's role in regulating behavior
- Vague response
Examples: New York socialite Pauline Sabin heard Ella Boole; reflected modern "new women" of the 1920s; did a lot of what we think of as typical; stock market crash of 1929; as an organization they changed Prohibition
- No response

Document 5

. . . The end of the Prohibition era marked the demise of a moral crusade meant to impose a uniform standard of social behavior in the United States. Unrealistic and unforgiving, Prohibition had allowed a vocal minority to regulate the personal habits of all Americans, especially those who lived and worked in cities like New York. While the desire of the dry crusade to uplift and improve the United States by banning alcohol and the saloon had in some ways been understandable in the Progressive era that spawned the Prohibition movement, the shortcomings of the dry crusade manifested themselves as soon as the dry experiment had begun. Anachronistic [outdated] and unworkable, the Prohibition experiment was ill suited to the diversity and dynamic of the modern United States, which by the 1920s had grown too large and too varied a nation to be governed by an impulse as intrusive as the dry crusade. Despite the force of federal law, the use of authoritarian tactics to enforce it, and the expenditure of millions of dollars a year, in fourteen years Prohibition succeeded neither in changing Americans' behavior nor in eliminating the problems caused by alcohol abuse. When Prohibition failed, and it did so spectacularly, it revealed the limits of moral reform movements, and specifically the paternalistic, prejudiced, and undemocratic ideals behind the dry crusade. . . .

Source: Michael A. Lerner, *Dry Manhattan: Prohibition in New York City*, Harvard University Press, 2007

35 According to Michael A. Lerner, what has been *one* impact of the efforts to address Prohibition?

Score of 1:

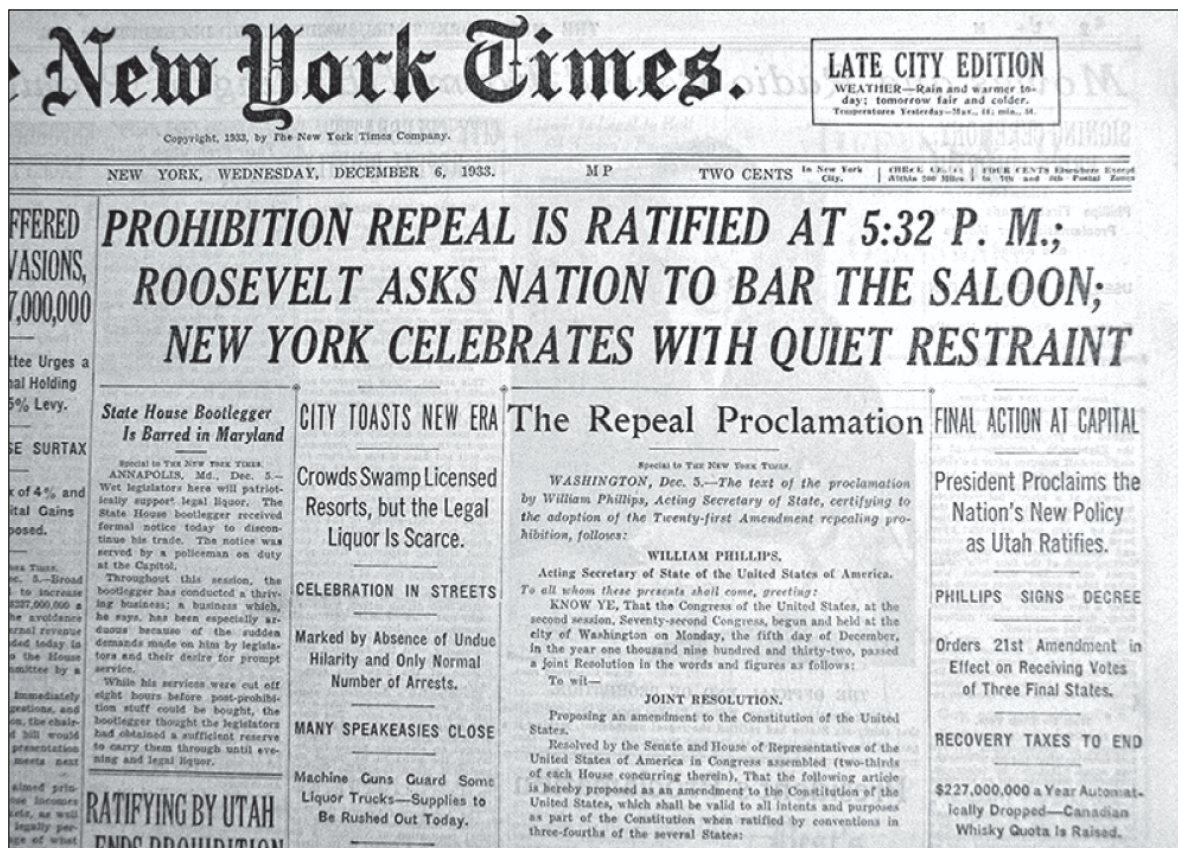
- States an impact of the efforts to address Prohibition according to Michael A. Lerner
Examples: demise of moral crusade meant to impose uniform standard of social behavior in United States; Prohibition allowed vocal minority to regulate personal habits of all Americans, especially those who lived and worked in cities such as New York; shortcomings of Prohibition manifested themselves as soon as dry experiment began; Prohibition outdated/unworkable; Prohibition ill-suited to diversity/dynamic of modern United States; by 1920s United States grown too large/too varied to be governed by Prohibition; in 14 years Prohibition did not change Americans' behavior/eliminate problems caused by alcohol abuse despite force of federal law/use of authoritarian tactics to enforce it/expenditure of millions of dollars a year; revealed limits of moral reform movements; revealed paternalistic/prejudiced/undemocratic ideals behind Prohibition

Score of 0:

- Incorrect response
Examples: no effect on those who lived and worked in cities such as New York; Prohibition eliminated problems caused by alcohol abuse; enforcement did not include authoritarian tactics
- Vague response
Examples: marked the demise; allowed a vocal minority; saloon in some ways understandable in Progressive Era; Progressive Era spawned Prohibition; it ended
- No response

Document 6

Although President Franklin Roosevelt supported repeal of Prohibition, he wanted to ban the operation of saloons, bars, and taverns in the United States.



Source: *New York Times*, December 6, 1933

36 Based on this document, what is *one* impact of the efforts to address Prohibition?

Score of 1:

- States an impact of the efforts to address Prohibition based on this document
Examples: Ratification of Prohibition repeal; support of President Franklin D. Roosevelt for repeal of Prohibition/asks nation to bar operation of saloons/bars/taverns; quiet celebration of repeal in New York; Utah ratification of Prohibition; crowds swamp licensed resorts but legal liquor scarce; celebration in New York streets; closing of many speakeasies; guarding of liquor supplies by machine guns; barring of state house bootlegger in Maryland; certification of 21st amendment by Acting Secretary of State Phillips; 21st amendment in effect on receiving three final states' votes

Score of 0:

- Incorrect response
Examples: Utah failed to ratify 21st amendment; only three states ratified 21st amendment; President Franklin Roosevelt opposed Prohibition repeal; many new speakeasies open
- Vague response
Examples: final action at Capital; undue hilarity; only normal number of arrests; supplies to be rushed out; society got better
- No response